

UNIVERSITY OF ESSEX

Undergraduate Examinations 2016

CURRENT DISPUTES IN SOCIOLOGY: SOCIOLOGICAL ANALYSIS III

Time allowed: **THREE** hours

Candidates are permitted to bring into the examination room paper dictionaries (with the title in English).

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

The paper consists of **eighteen** questions in total: nine in each Section.

All questions are of equal weight.

Please do not leave your seat unless you are given permission by an invigilator. Do not communicate in any way with any other candidate in the examination room. Do not open the question paper until told to do so. All answers must be written in the answer book(s) provided. All rough work must be written in the answer book(s) provided. A line should be drawn through any rough work to indicate to the examiner that it is not part of the work to be marked. At the end of the examination, remain seated until your answer book(s) have been collected and you have been told you may leave.

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION A

1. “Power is not repressive; it is productive”. Critically assess this statement and its implications for social theory.
2. Outline and assess what Foucault means by the term “governmentality”?
3. How useful is Bourdieu’s notion of “habitus” for understanding contemporary society?
4. According to Barthes, in what ways can popular culture be said to be ideological?
5. What difficulties has sociology had in theorizing nature? What approaches might be adopted to overcome these problems?
6. Do postmodernist theorists really believe that “nothing is real”?
7. Can feminism theorise the lives of all women? Or do we really need to talk about feminisms?
8. Does feminist epistemology reject the concept of objectivity?
9. What explanations have sociologists provided to explain why the rich have become richer across the world over the last 30 years?

END OF SECTION A

Candidates must answer **THREE** questions: **ONE** from **SECTION A**, **ONE** from **SECTION B** and **ONE** from **EITHER** Section.

SECTION B

10. Does all sociological knowledge have to be based, ultimately, on experience?
11. Is all sociological knowledge, ultimately, based on interpretation of the social world?
12. “In order to understand the social world, we need to understand how members of a society come to classify the phenomena of their world”. Critically evaluate this statement.
13. Why do Critical Realists think it necessary to talk of “the real, the actual and the empirical”? How useful is this approach for understanding the social world?
14. Is knowledge only scientific if it is falsifiable?
15. How important are Du Bois’ ideas about the “experience of race” for analysing the world today?
16. With reference to the work of at least two writers on post-colonial theory, assess the extent to which “the West” has constructed ideas and realities about “others”.
17. “How we perceive the world is always a question of power.” Critically assess this statement.
18. Critically analyse Latour’s concept of “Actor-Network-Theory”.

END OF SECTION B

END OF PAPER